



You may be closely monitored in the hospital toward the end of your pregnancy if there is any concern about your health or that of your baby. A fetal monitoring machine will be used to check your baby's heartbeat.

PRESCRIBED BEDREST

Toward the end of pregnancy, there are some circumstances when you may need to be admitted to the hospital for observation.

- **If you have developed [preeclampsia](#),** so that measures can be taken to reduce your blood pressure.
- **If you have any vaginal bleeding** that may be due to a [low-lying placenta](#) or a [placental abruption](#).

GETTING STRONG

Maintaining muscular strength, stretching, and doing gentle exercise right up until you give birth will help your posture—minimizing backaches, reducing stress on your skeleton, and making you feel more energized and relaxed. As long as you feel good and adhere to the guidelines outlined on page 18, you can continue with your activities.